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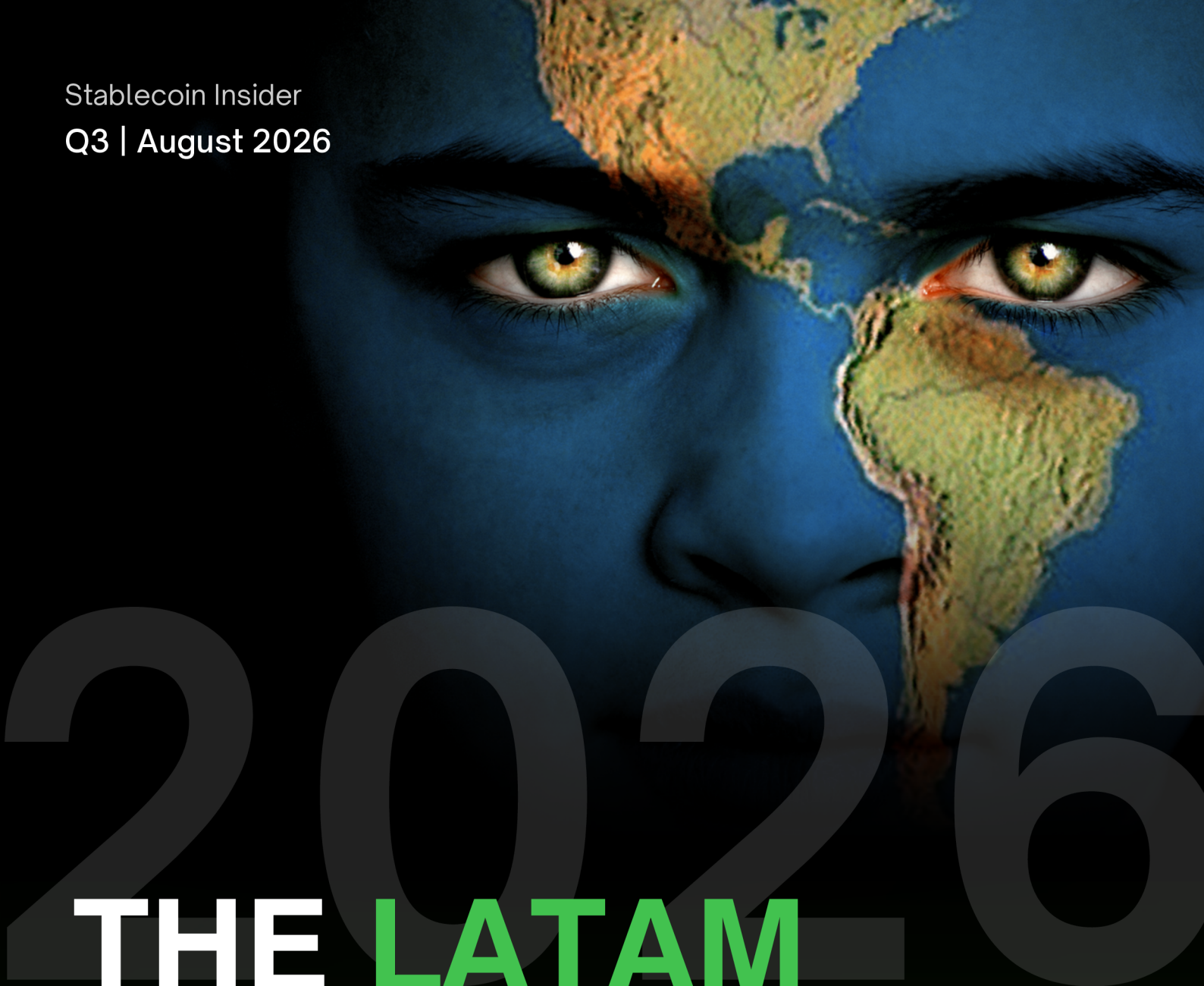

2026

THE LATAM STABLECOIN ECONOMY 2026

Infrastructure, Players & the Institutional Opportunity

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1

Executive Summary

Executive Summary

Latin America's stablecoin economy grew out of the broader crypto adoption wave, but what sustains it today is different: stablecoins solved five specific, persistent, measurable problems (inflation, dollar scarcity, remittance costs, rail fragmentation, and underbanking), and the market has visibly reorganised around that utility.

The evidence now spans every layer: retail savings, business supplier payments, card spending, payroll, and regulated interbank settlement. Across all of them, the same pattern repeats: stablecoins win on speed, dollar access and working capital efficiency. End users don't think about blockchain, and the last mile into local currency stays on regulated local rails. That is what settlement infrastructure looks like. The operator record assembled for this report confirms the thesis at every layer of the stack.

Trade Settlement

In trade settlement, Mandioca has processed over $1 billion across 100+ enterprise clients, with more than 90% of volume tied to real trade activity and settlement compressed from 2-5 days to minutes (Source: Mandioca company data).

Asia-Latam Corridor

On the Asia-Latam corridor, VelaFi recorded 300%+ volume growth in 2025, led by supplier payments and with SMBs now the fastest-growing client segment (Source: VelaFi company data).

Regulated Settlement

Through its regulated subsidiaries and partners, Transnetwork LLC and its subsidiaries ("Movantis") routes stablecoin and traditional rails through a single integration across a network of 50+ money transmitters and banks, 90,000+ payout locations, and $63B+ in annual volume (Source: Movantis company data).

Cards Issuance

In cards, Pomelo issues across 170+ clients and 150+ countries with deep roots in Latin America. Banks, fintechs, and crypto companies, settle directly in USDC to eliminate the FX layer for stablecoin-treasury companies, given that domestic card transactions typically cost just 5-15% of cross-border ones (Sources: Pomelo company data).

Payroll

In payroll, Rise's platform data shows sustained Latam demand for stablecoin payout options, anchored by Argentina, in a global market where stablecoins already account for over 90% of crypto payroll transactions (Sources: Rise company data; Rise Stablecoin Payroll Report).

The five defining numbers

Cumulative Latam crypto transaction volume, Jul 2022 to Jun 2025

~$1.5 T

(SOURCE: CHAINALYSIS)

Share of Brazil's crypto flows that are stablecoin-related

90%+

(SOURCE: CHAINALYSIS)

YoY growth in global B2B stablecoin payments in 2025, to $226B

733%

(SOURCE: THE DEFIANT)

Value moved via stablecoins in Latam in 2025 (+89% YoY)

$324 B

(SOURCE: GO MARKETS, CITING CHAINALYSIS)

Global average cost of a $200 legacy remittance, Q3 2025

6.36%

(SOURCE: WORLD BANK REMITTANCE PRICES WORLDWIDE)

One takeaway per chapter

Why Latam

The macro conditions that broke Latam's monetary systems are exactly the conditions stablecoins were built to route around.

The Market Size

The market has crossed from retail hedging into B2B settlement; supplier payments, not savings, are now the growth engine.

The Infrastructure

Five distinct layers have professionalised and the last mile still runs on regulated local rails.

The Ecosystem

Specialised operators now own each layer: trade settlement, enterprise corridors, cards, payroll, regulated networks.

The Corridors

Three corridor families exist (Latam-US, Latam-Asia, intra-Latam) and stablecoins win each for a different reason.

CFO & Treasurer Primer

The business case is settlement in minutes instead of days and released working capital, not lower fees.

2

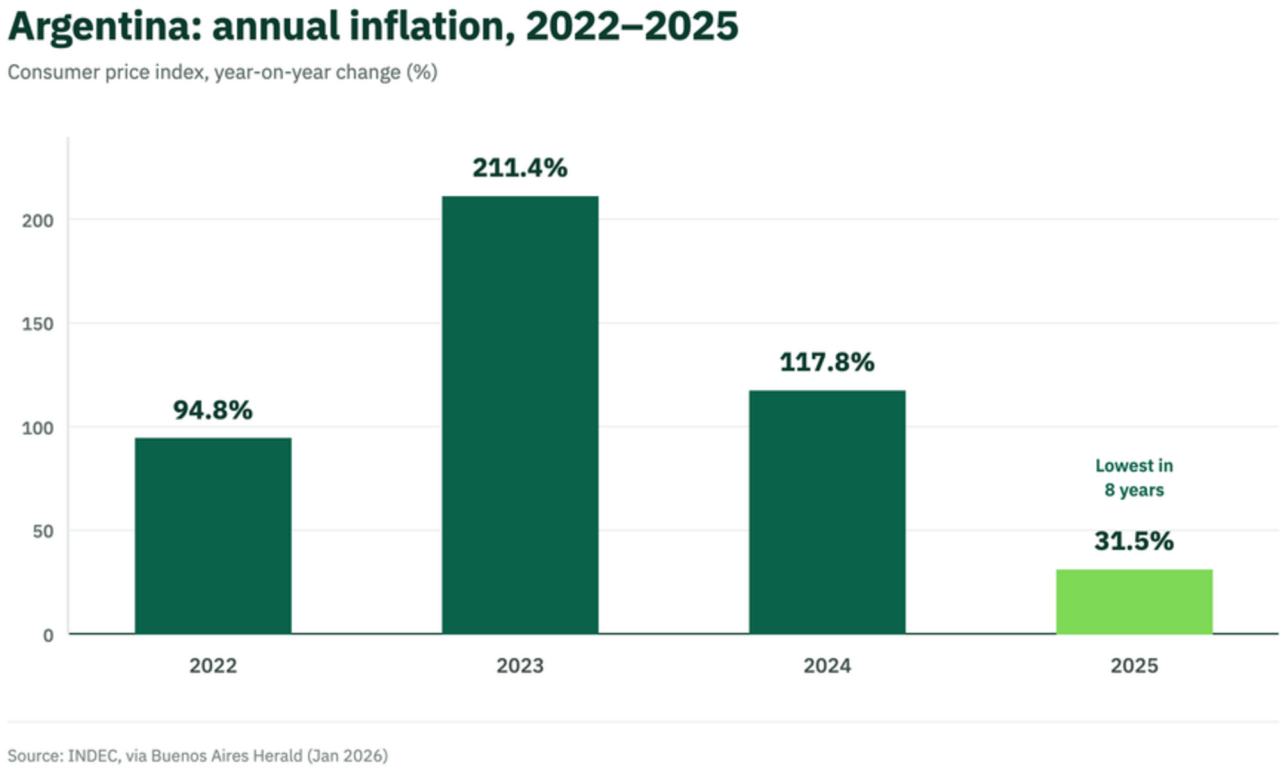
Why Latam

Why Latin America Is the World's Stablecoin Proof Point

How does inflation drive stablecoin adoption?

The Argentina case

Argentina closed 2023 with the world's highest inflation at 211.4%, cut it to 117.8% in 2024, and reached 31.5% in 2025, the lowest reading in eight years (Source: Buenos Aires Herald, citing INDEC). By mid-2026 the rate had ticked back to 33.5% (Source: Trading Economics). Even in its best year in nearly a decade, a peso saver lost roughly a third of their purchasing power. That arithmetic is the foundation of everything else in this chapter: **when the local unit of account fails at its most basic job, demand migrates to whatever instrument holds dollar value with the least friction**.



The behavioural response is measurable at every level of the market. **Stablecoins account for over 60% of Argentina's crypto activity,** and the country reached 12% monthly active crypto user penetration in 2025, more than a quarter of all regional activity (Source: GO Markets, citing Chainalysis).

USDT and USDC made up 72% of all crypto purchases on the country's largest exchange in 2024 versus just 8% for Bitcoin, and trading activity reliably spikes around salary dates as workers convert pay into digital dollars to preserve value (Source: Dune / Bitso). **Retail-sized stablecoin value received in Argentina has grown faster than any other asset type**, direct evidence that citizens use these tokens to mitigate devaluation rather than to speculate (Source: Chainalysis).

Inflation reshapes labour markets, not just savings.

Historically, many skilled professionals in markets like Argentina faced limits when working with international employers because cross-border payment infrastructure was slow, expensive, or unreliable, while global companies were restricted in hiring from the region because of payment complexity and currency volatility.

Stablecoin payroll removes both barriers at once by enabling fast, low-cost, dollar-denominated payments, allowing employers and workers to collaborate regardless of geography (Source: Rise company data).

Matías Reyes, FIBD Director & Argentina Country Manager, VelaFi, shares with us:

However, reducing the Argentine phenomenon to inflation alone would be incomplete. The underlying issue is less the level of inflation than the volatility in demand for the peso itself, particularly during binary political junctures — 2015, 2019, and 2023 stand out as clear examples — where uncertainty over an electoral or policy outcome triggers an abrupt flight to cover. Historically, this has driven the population toward the dollar as a store of value, amplifying the impact of these discrete events on the monetary system as a whole.

Compounding this, **exchange-rate pass-through to prices during such episodes exhibits an unusually high correlation**: devaluation transmits almost immediately into inflation, further eroding confidence in the local currency. Looking ahead, Argentina faces another such test in 2027, when the next presidential election is due; **the hope is that the economy will be able to absorb this binary juncture without reverting to the sharpest dynamics of past cycles**.

This pattern is not unique to Argentina, either in its past or prospective form; it recurs across other economies marked by structurally high inflation and weak demand for the local currency, **where stablecoins offer a technical workaround to a problem that is, at its root, one of institutional and monetary credibility rather than price levels alone**.

Venezuela shows what the endpoint of this dynamic looks like after years of hyperinflation and informal dollarization: the country consistently ranks in the global top 20 for grassroots crypto adoption, and peer-to-peer stablecoin usage is so entrenched that Tron has surpassed Ethereum as its main stablecoin settlement layer (Sources: Chainalysis; Presto Research).

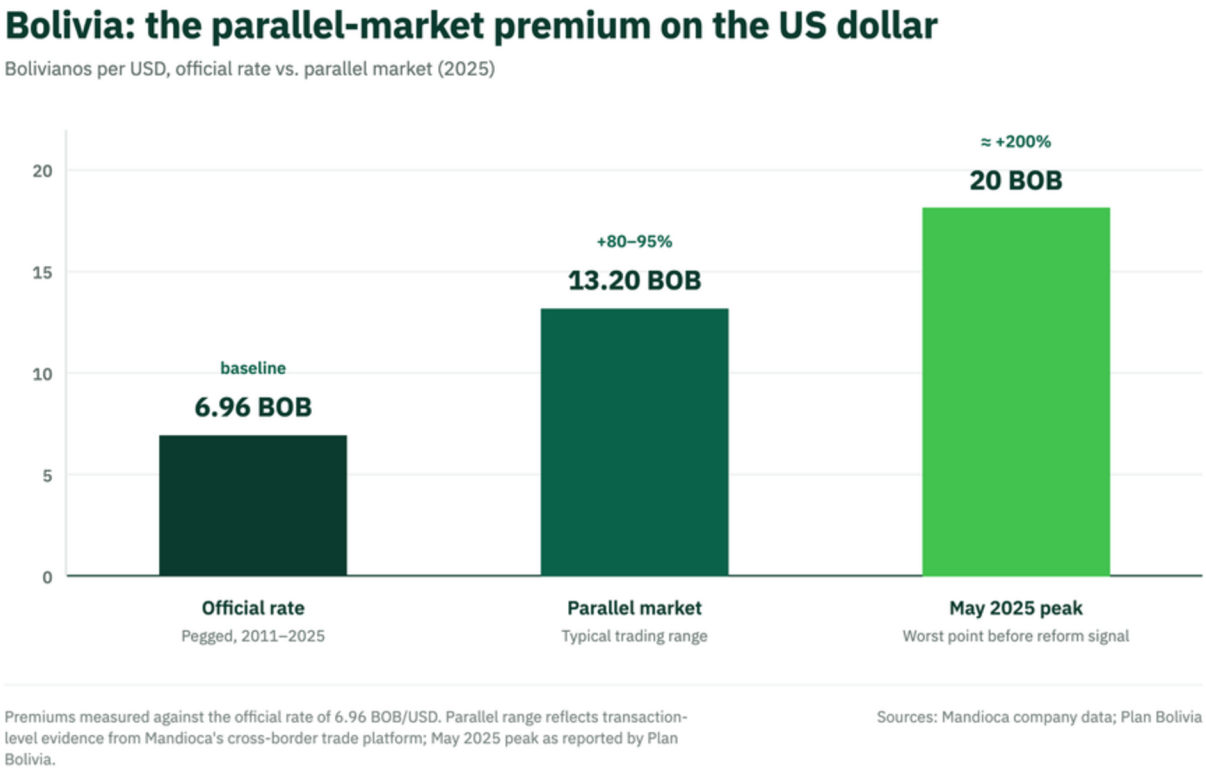
Argentina in 2022, Venezuela over the past decade, and Bolivia today are **the same story at three different stages.**

What happens when a country runs out of dollars?

The Bolivia case

Bolivia is the region's starkest current example of official dollar channels failing outright. The country held its official exchange rate at 6.86-6.96 bolivianos per US dollar from 2011 until mounting pressure on foreign exchange reserves forced the government to abandon the long-standing peg; the resulting dollar shortage fuelled a parallel foreign exchange market where the dollar traded at a steep premium to the official rate (Source: Cointelegraph, citing Reuters).

Transaction-level evidence from Mandioca's cross-border trade platform recorded parallel premiums of 80-95% above the official rate, making dollar access increasingly difficult for any business paying international suppliers (Source: Mandioca company data). At the worst point, in May 2025, the parallel rate was reported near 20 BOB per USD, a premium of roughly 200%, before stabilising after the incoming government signalled a move to a floating exchange rate (Source: Plan Bolivia).



Stablecoins became the workaround, then the policy. **Bolivia recorded $14.8 billion in crypto transaction volume over the twelve months** measured in Chainalysis' 2025 regional analysis, remarkable for a country that banned crypto outright until 2024 (Source: Cointelegraph). S**tate-controlled Banco Unión began supporting USDT purchases through its Yasta wallet** in April 2026 for international payments and remittances, Banco FIE launched USDT buy/sell through its mobile app, and the Economy Ministry is now formally evaluating a **framework that would recognise USDT as a payment instrument circulating alongside the boliviano and the dollar,** with AML safeguards attached (Source: Coin Insider). A government designing a regulatory framework around a dollar stablecoin, because its businesses already run on one, is the proof-point thesis of this report in a single country.

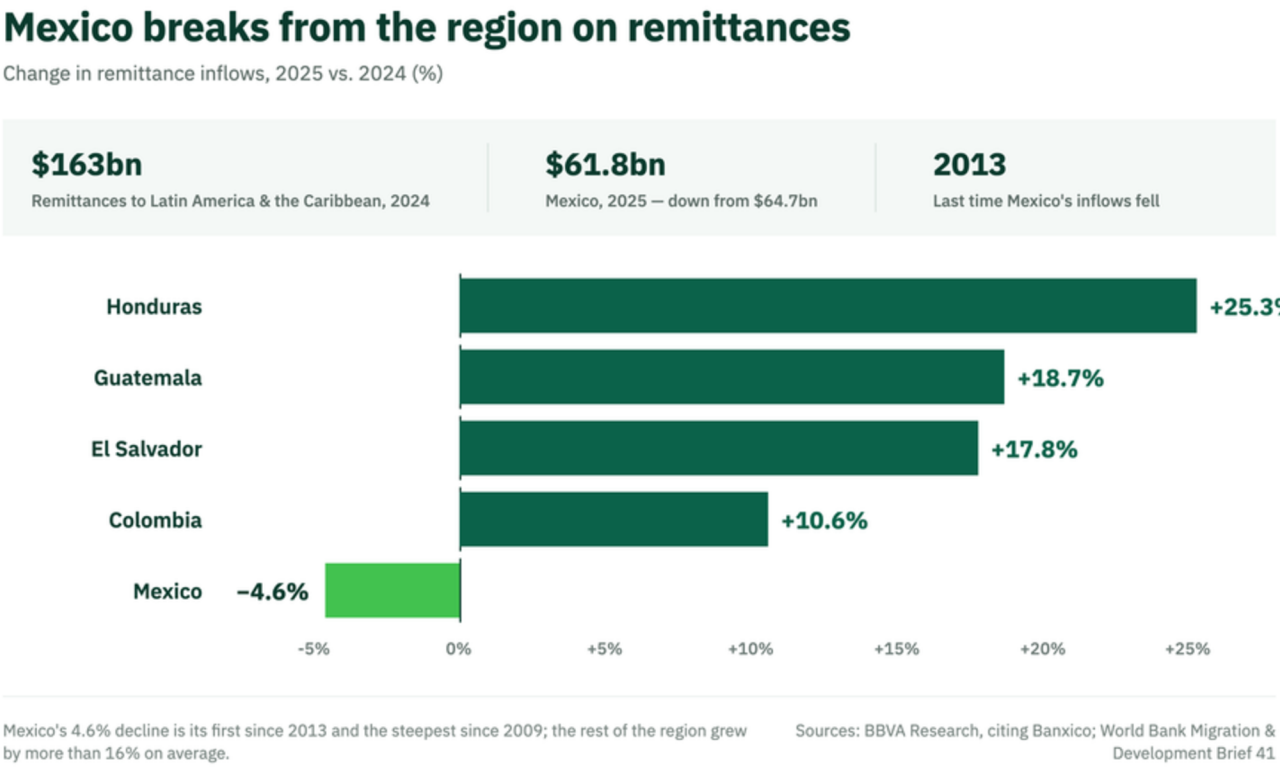
FX volatility as a business problem: The Colombia case

Colombia illustrates the softer version of the same condition: volatility rather than scarcity. **The peso moved from roughly COP 3,822 per USD at end-2023 to COP 4,409 at end-2024**, a depreciation of approximately 15% in a single year, enough to materially impact margins and working capital planning for any importer whose suppliers invoice in dollars (Source: Mandioca company data). The retail market responded in parallel with the corporate one: **stablecoins made up 48% of Colombia's crypto purchases in 2024**, aided by restrictions on USD bank accounts and persistent currency volatility (Source: Dune / Bitso). For a Colombian importer, holding working capital in a dollar token between invoice receipt and payment date is not a crypto position, it is **margin protection.**

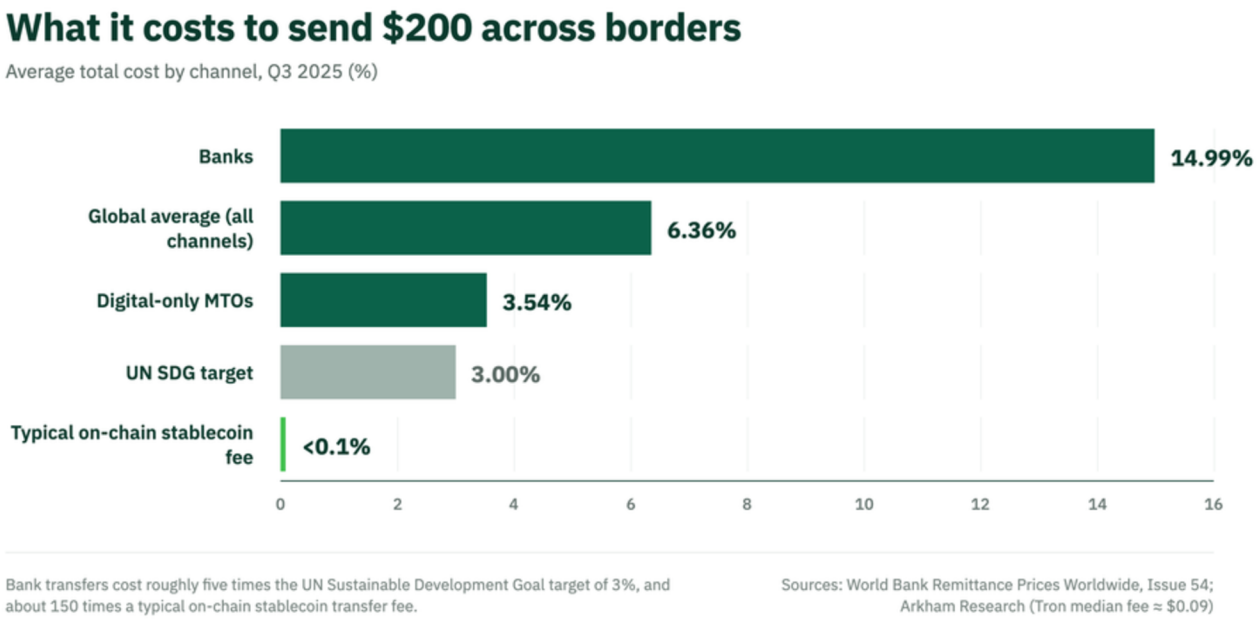
Remittance dependence and what it costs

Latin America and the Caribbean received approximately **$163 billion in remittances in 2024**, with Mexico alone accounting for $64.7 billion (Source: World Bank Migration & Development Brief 41, via InternationalMoneyTransfer.com).

In 2025 Mexico's **inflows fell 4.6% to $61.8 billion, the first decline since 2013 and the largest since 2009**, while remittances to the rest of Latin America and the Caribbean grew by more than 16% on average, including Honduras +25.3%, Guatemala +18.7%, El Salvador +17.8%, and Colombia +10.6% (Source: BBVA Research, citing Banxico).



Moving that money through legacy channels remains far above policy targets. The global average cost of sending $200 was 6.36% in Q3 2025; banks, the most expensive channel, averaged 14.99%, and even digital-only money transfer operators averaged 3.54%, still above the UN Sustainable Development Goal target of 3% (Source: World Bank RPW, Issue 54). On the dominant retail stablecoin chain, **the comparable on-chain transfer cost is measured in cents: median fees of roughly $0.09** (Source: Arkham Research). The wholesale leg of the corridor, in other words, has been repriced by two orders of magnitude; what remains costly is the regulated last mile.



The paradox: fragmented banking, world-class local rails

Latin America pairs weak cross-border banking with some of the best domestic payment systems on Earth:

SYSTEM	COUNTRY	SCALE (LATEST)
PIX	Brazil	79.8B transactions in 2025 (up from 63.5B in 2024); R$35.4T moved; 93% of adults
Bre-B	Colombia	617M+ transactions in the first six months after its Oct 2025 launch; 218 institutions, 33M users
SPEI / CVU / Bre-B	Mexico / Argentina / Colombia	National real-time transfer standards

None of these systems interoperate, and none cross borders. Each country is its own market with different regulatory frameworks, FX controls, and preferred payment methods, and **that fragmentation has been a structural barrier to regional scale for any business operating across markets** (Source: VelaFi company data).

Stablecoins have become the interoperability layer between them: the cross-border leg travels on-chain, and the last mile lands on whichever local rail the beneficiary actually uses. The strength of the domestic rails is therefore not competition for stablecoins; it is what makes the stablecoin model work, because the final disbursement leg is instant, cheap, and universally accepted.

The underbanked population

Account ownership among adults in Latin America and the Caribbean **rose from 39% in 2011 to 70% in 2024,** real progress that still leaves roughly three in ten adults without a financial account and the region five percentage points behind the average for low- and middle-income countries (Source: World Bank Global Findex 2025, via FinDev Gateway). Mobile money is closing the gap fastest: **37% of adults held a mobile money account in 2024**, up 15 points from 2021, and the **growth of digitally enabled accounts is driving the region's formal savings rate from 18% in 2021 to 29% in 2024** (Source: World Bank Global Findex 2025). Meanwhile, an estimated 57.7 million Latin Americans, about 12% of the population, already held digital currencies by early 2025 (Source: Coinchange).

For a meaningful share of the region, **a stablecoin wallet is the first dollar-denominated account they have ever held.**

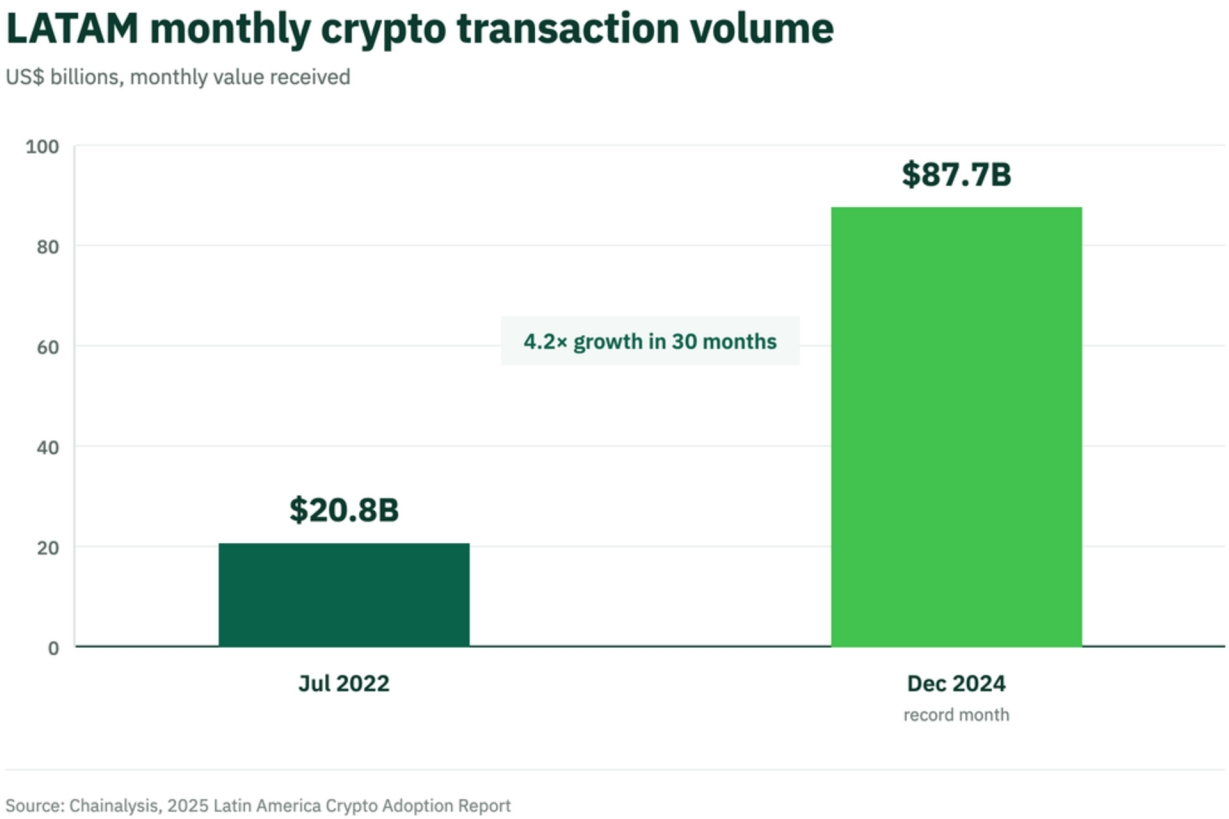
3

The Market Size

Market Size: The Latam Stablecoin Economy in Numbers

How big is the Latam crypto and stablecoin market?

Latin America recorded nearly **$1.5 trillion in cumulative cryptocurrency transaction volume between July 2022 and June 2025**, with monthly activity climbing from $20.8 billion in mid-2022 to a record $87.7 billion in December 2024, a more than fourfold increase in thirty months (Source: Chainalysis, via Yahoo Finance). In 2025, **regional on-chain volume rose 60% year-on-year**; of the $730 billion received during the year, $324 billion moved through stablecoin transactions, an 89% year-on-year surge, and monthly active crypto users grew 18%, three times faster than in the United States (Source: GO Markets, citing Chainalysis).



Two structural features distinguish the region from other crypto markets.

1. Stablecoin Purchases

First, stablecoin purchases exceed half of all exchange purchases in countries like Brazil, Argentina, and Colombia, meaning the asset mix is payments-shaped rather than speculation-shaped (Source: Chainalysis).

2. Latam Crypto Activity

Second, 64% of Latam crypto activity takes place on centralized exchanges, higher than North America or Europe, which primes the region for infrastructure that seamlessly connects on-chain stablecoin holdings to off-chain spending through cards and local-rail off-ramps (Source: Pomelo company data, citing Chainalysis).

Within the regional total, **the flows split into four working categories**, each mapped to a corridor family in Chapter 5:

- consumer savings and P2P (the retail base built during the inflation years),
- remittances (concentrated on the US corridor),
- B2B trade settlement (concentrated on the Asia corridor and growing fastest),
- institutional transfers (Brazil-led, with institutional and large corporate transfers both growing in excess of 100% period-over-period in the last measured window)

(Source: Chainalysis).

The B2B inflection: where the growth actually is

The defining shift of 2025-2026 is **the migration of stablecoin volume from retail hedging into business settlement.** It is worth being precise about what is and is not growing. Globally, raw stablecoin transaction volume reached roughly $35 trillion annualized, but **only about $390 billion of that represented genuine real-economy payments** such as vendor invoices, remittances, payroll, and card spending; the rest is trading, internal transfers, and market activity (Source: McKinsey & Artemis, via AMBCrypto). Within that real-payments universe:

B2B transactions

B2B transactions accounted for roughly 60% at $226 billion, up 733% year-on-year, driven primarily by supply-chain payments, cross-border supplier settlement, and treasury liquidity management (Source: McKinsey & Artemis, via AMBCrypto).

Payroll and remittances

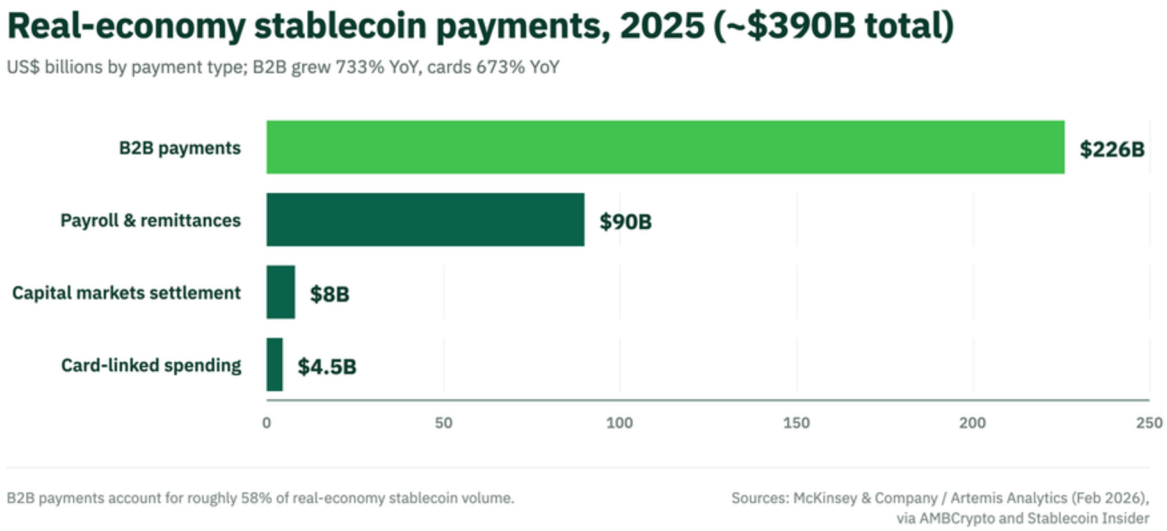
Payroll and remittances contributed roughly $90 billion, capital markets settlement $8 billion, and card-linked spending $4.5 billion, with cards the second-fastest grower at 673% year-on-year (Source: Stablecoin Insider analysis of McKinsey/Artemis data).

B2B volume

Monthly B2B stablecoin volume grew roughly 30-fold in two years, from under $100 million in early 2023 to over $3 billion by 2025 (Source: Artemis / Castle Island Ventures / Dragonfly, via Reap).

Adoption SMEs

Adoption is concentrated among small and medium-sized businesses seeking faster settlement, not just large corporates (Source: The Defiant).



Latam operator data mirrors the global curve almost exactly. **Asia-Latam settlement infrastructure processed 300%+ volume growth in 2025 versus 2024**, driven primarily by import/export and logistics clients, with demand still accelerating: 20%+ growth recorded in the three months to mid-2026 alone, and SMBs now among the fastest-growing client segments by count (Source: VelaFi company data).

The use case seeing the clearest, highest-volume adoption is **supplier payments**, settling invoices to Asian counterparties in stablecoins to avoid correspondent banking delays, FX slippage, and unpredictable settlement windows; **treasury-style** use cases such as liquidity management and FX hedging remain early and limited to a small number of larger clients experimenting with **holding stablecoins as part of broader strategy** (Source: VelaFi company data).

For a small business importing from Asia, **a stablecoin-based supplier payment is the difference between a shipment moving or not** (Source: VelaFi company data).

> Everyone built for the large corporate first and assumed SMBs would follow once the rails matured. We're seeing the opposite: **small businesses with Asia-facing supply chains are adopting faster than anyone, because they're the ones with no alternative.**
>
> No treasury team, no banking relationship that can absorb a slow settlement. They're not early adopters.
> They're the ones with the most to gain.
>
> **HONGYI TANG,**
> **GLOBAL HEAD OF REVENUE, VELAFI**

Adoption segmentation: Retail → B2B → Institutional

The global supply base underpinning this stood at roughly **$300-316 billion in mid-2026**, a 30x increase from mid-2020, with USDT at ~59% and USDC at ~24% of supply (Sources: The Block; Transak, citing DefiLlama). Usage has decoupled from supply: adjusted transaction volume **hit a record $1.79 trillion in June 2026** even as market cap contracted slightly following the GENIUS Act's yield prohibition, evidence that stablecoins are evolving from a hybrid savings-and-spending instrument into a purely transactional one (Source: Crypto Briefing).

Independent industry surveys point the same direction: **adjusted stablecoin transfer volume reached roughly $9 trillion** over the trailing year per a16z's measurement methodology, confirming that transactional usage, not parked supply, is the growth variable (Source: Transak, citing a16z). For Latam specifically, that decoupling is a feature, not a warning sign: the region's demand was always transactional.

Three phases of stablecoin adoption in Latin America

From retail dollar savings to institutional settlement

PHASE	PERIOD	DOMINANT USE CASE	EVIDENCE
Retail	2020–2023	Inflation hedging, dollar savings	Retail-sized stablecoin value in Argentina grew faster than any other asset type. Source: Chainalysis
B2B	2024–present	Supplier payments, trade settlement, payroll	+733% global B2B growth; 300%+ growth in LATAM corridors. Sources: AMBCrypto; VelaFi company data
Institutional	Opening now	Interbank settlement, card-network settlement	Brazil's institutional transfers grew more than 100% period-over-period; Visa launched US USDC settlement in Dec 2025. Sources: Chainalysis; The Asian Banker

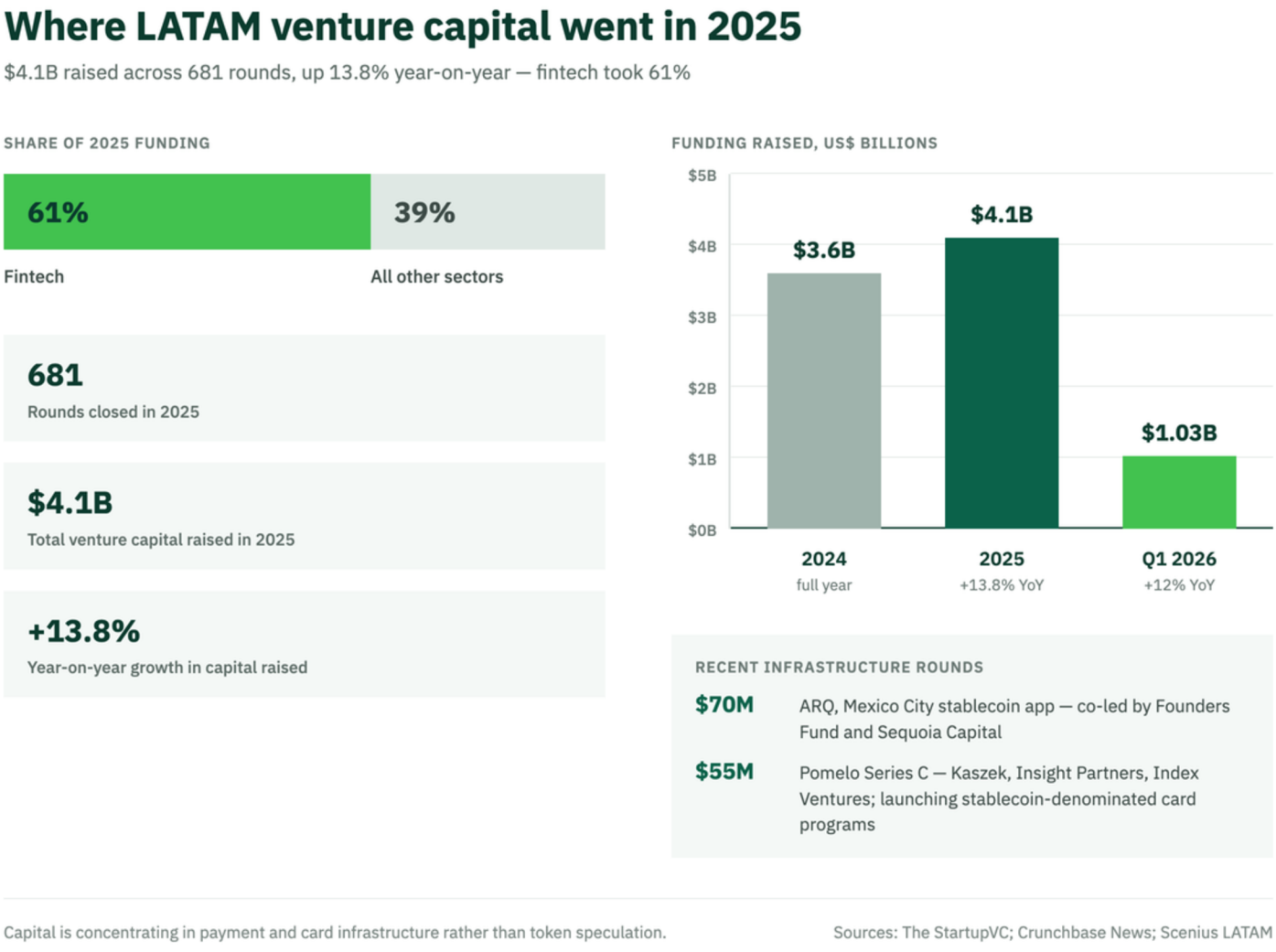
Sources: Chainalysis; AMBCrypto; VelaFi company data; The Asian Banker.

Funding snapshot: capital follows the volume

Latam startups raised $4.1 billion in venture capital across 681 rounds in 2025, up 13.8% year-on-year, with fintech capturing 61% of all funding (Source: The StartupVC). Investors explicitly name stablecoins as the driver: 2025 was described by active regional investors as "**all about stablecoins and fintech infrastructure**," and the momentum carried into Q1 2026, when Latam startups raised $1.03 billion, up 12% year-on-year, including a $70 million round for Mexico City-based stablecoin app ARQ co-led by Founders Fund and Sequoia Capital (Source: Crunchbase News).

Card-infrastructure operator Pomelo closed a $55 million Series C backed by Kaszek, Insight Partners, and Index Ventures before launching stablecoin-denominated card programs (Source: Scenius Latam).

The funding pattern matches the volume pattern: capital is flowing to the infrastructure layers, not to token speculation.



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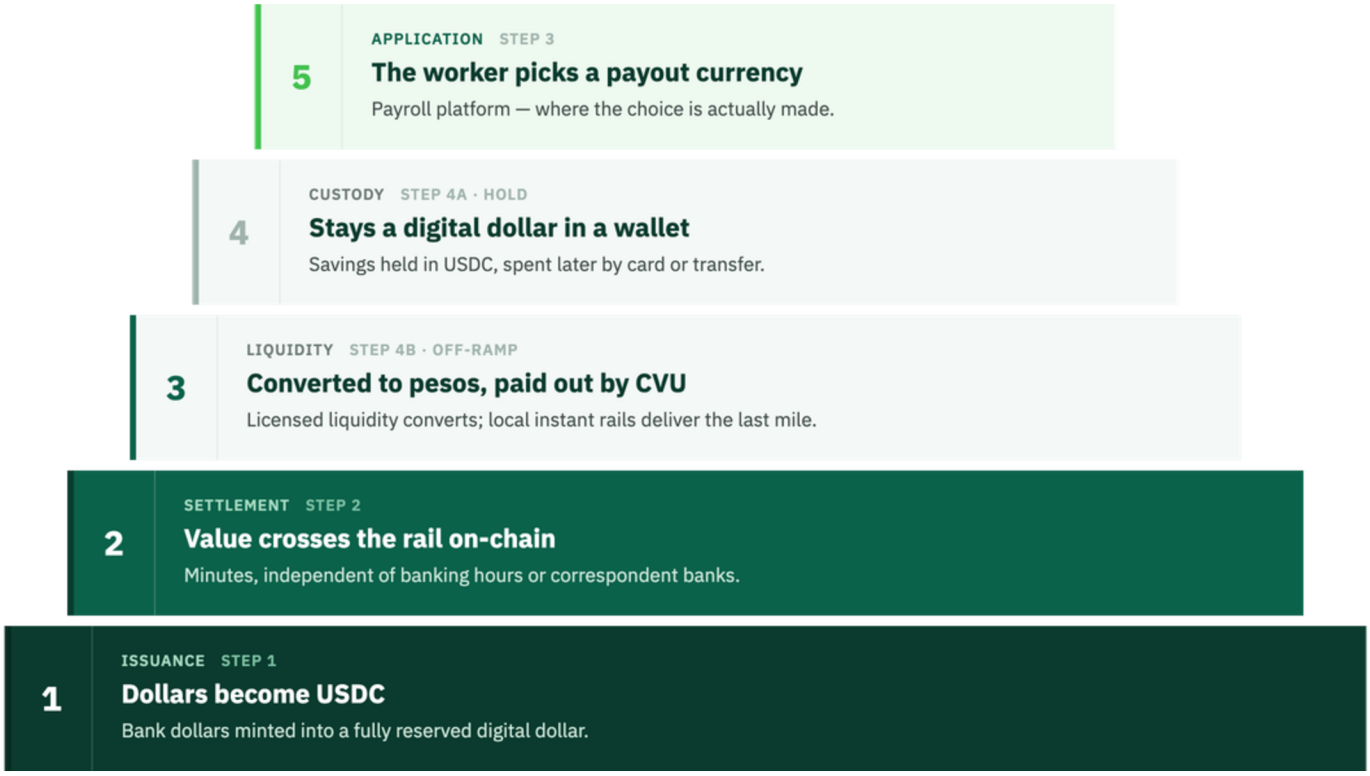
The Infrastructure

The Infrastructure Stack: How the Five Layers Connect



Layer 1 (Issuance): who mints the dollars

USDT and USDC together account for more than 90% of stablecoin transfer volume on regional exchanges, with USD-pegged tokens rising from around 60% of activity in 2022 to more than 90% in 2025; **for cross-border and treasury use cases, USD tokens are the natural default**, offering deep liquidity, near-universal acceptance, and a shared unit of account for international commerce (Source: Bitget). Both issuers now operate under formal law in their home jurisdictions: the US GENIUS Act, enacted in July 2025, established the first federal framework for payment stablecoins, mandating reserve standards and prohibiting yield payments to holders (Source: Forbes). **Local-currency stablecoins, notably BRL-pegged tokens integrated with PIX, are an emerging but still small category** (Source: Phoenix Strategy Group).

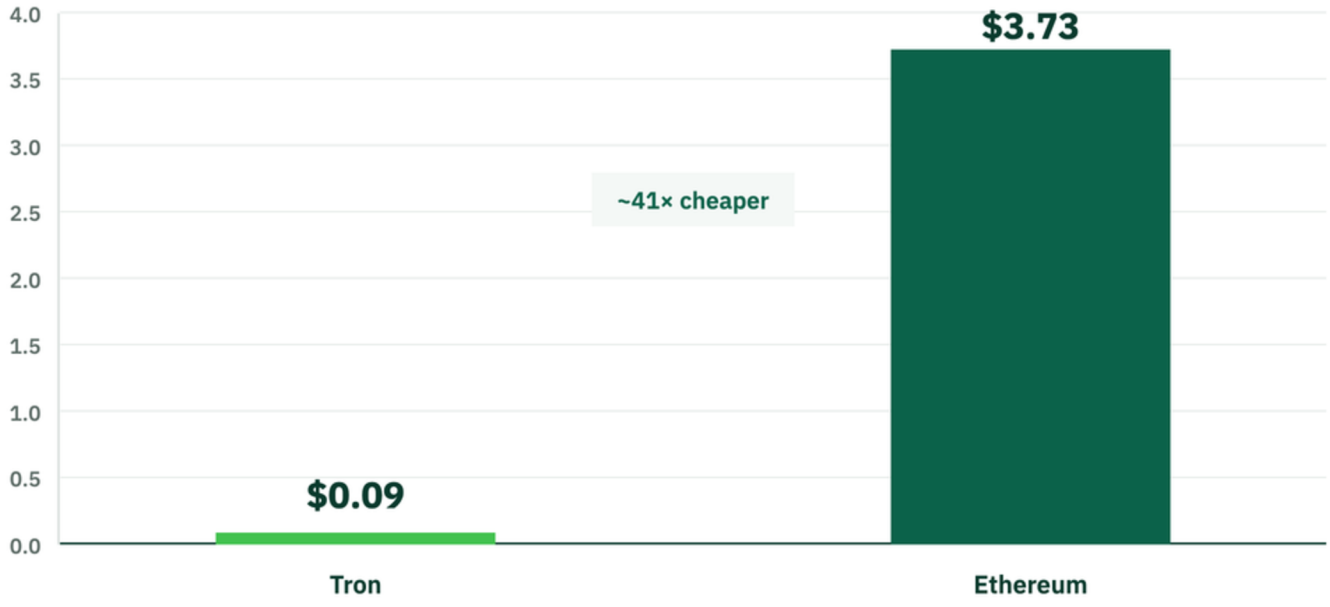
Layer 2 (Settlement rails): Chains and Networks

The chains Latam uses diverge sharply from crypto-industry attention:

RAIL	ROLE IN LATAM	KEY DATA
Tron	Default retail and remittance rail	▪ 65% of global retail USDT transfers (under $1,000) ▪ $7.9T in USDT transfers in 2025 ▪ More than 40% of Brazil's USDT transfers ▪ ~$0.09 median fee vs. $3.73 on Ethereum
Ethereum + L2s	Institutional settlement, DeFi collateral	▪ Largest chain by stablecoin supply
Solana	Fast-growing consumer and institutional rail	▪ Carries Visa's US USDC settlement

Why Tron carries LATAM's retail stablecoin flows

Median USDT transfer fee in USD; Tron also holds 65% of global retail (under $1,000) USDT transfers



A $200 remittance costs about 0.05% to move on Tron versus roughly 1.9% on Ethereum.

Sources: Arkham Research (fees); CoinDesk Research, TRON Network Q3 2025 (retail transfer share)

Regulated networks

A second kind of settlement rail matters just as much: **permissioned networks that embed stablecoins inside existing institutional plumbing**. The Circle Payments Network (CPN), launched in April 2025 as a coordination layer for banks, PSPs, and VASPs, **reached $8.3 billion in annualized transaction volume by March 2026**, and its Managed Payments product, launched April 2026, lets institutions settle in USDC while interacting entirely in fiat (Sources: Circle / PR Newswire; Bitcoin.com News).

This is where the region's legacy remittance infrastructure connects to on-chain settlement. **A network connecting 50+ money transmitters, banks, and 90,000+ payout locations**, historically reliant exclusively on correspondent banking, now routes both traditional and stablecoin rails through a single integration, with stablecoin settlement embedded as one more option the system can choose per transaction rather than a replacement (Source: Movantis company data).

Stablecoins add the most value on the **interbank and inter-correspondent leg**, the movement of value between institutions where speed of settlement and capital efficiency matter most, while **the last mile into local currency continues to run predominantly on regulated local rails**, because that is where the beneficiary actually receives the value (Source: Movantis company data).

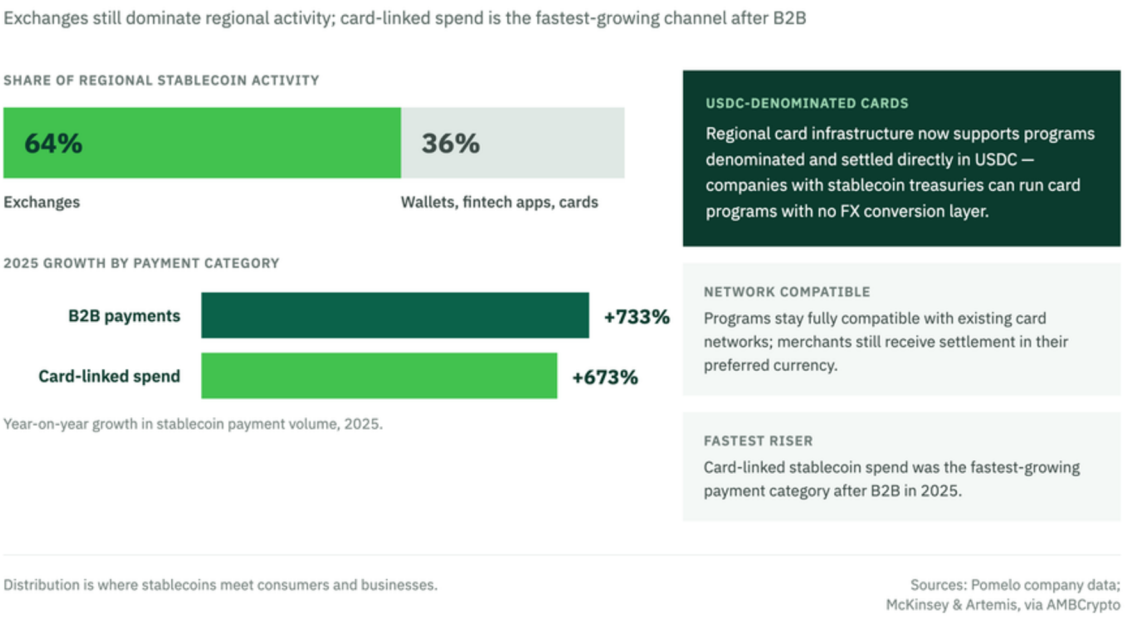
> In cross-border transactions, technology stopped being a constraint. What decides who scales in Latam is regulated standing on both ends of the corridor, and that is built over years, not bought.
>
> **Stablecoins do not remove that requirement. They run on top of it.**
>
> **GUSTAVO RUIZ,**
> **CHAIRMAN & CEO, MOVANTIS**

Layer 3 (On/off-ramps and liquidity): where fragmentation becomes engineering

The ramp layer converts between on-chain dollars and local currency, and it is where Latam's fragmentation becomes a build problem rather than a talking point. **Every corridor requires local liquidity, licensed conversion, and integration with each destination's domestic rail**: PIX in Brazil, SPEI in Mexico, CVU in Argentina, Bre-B in Colombia; infrastructure without that context fails operationally even when it works technically (Source: VelaFi company data). For B2B flows, trade-settlement platforms occupy this layer, giving importers and exporters same-day conversion between local currency and stablecoin-settled supplier payments across Latin America, Asia, and the US (Source: Mandioca company data).

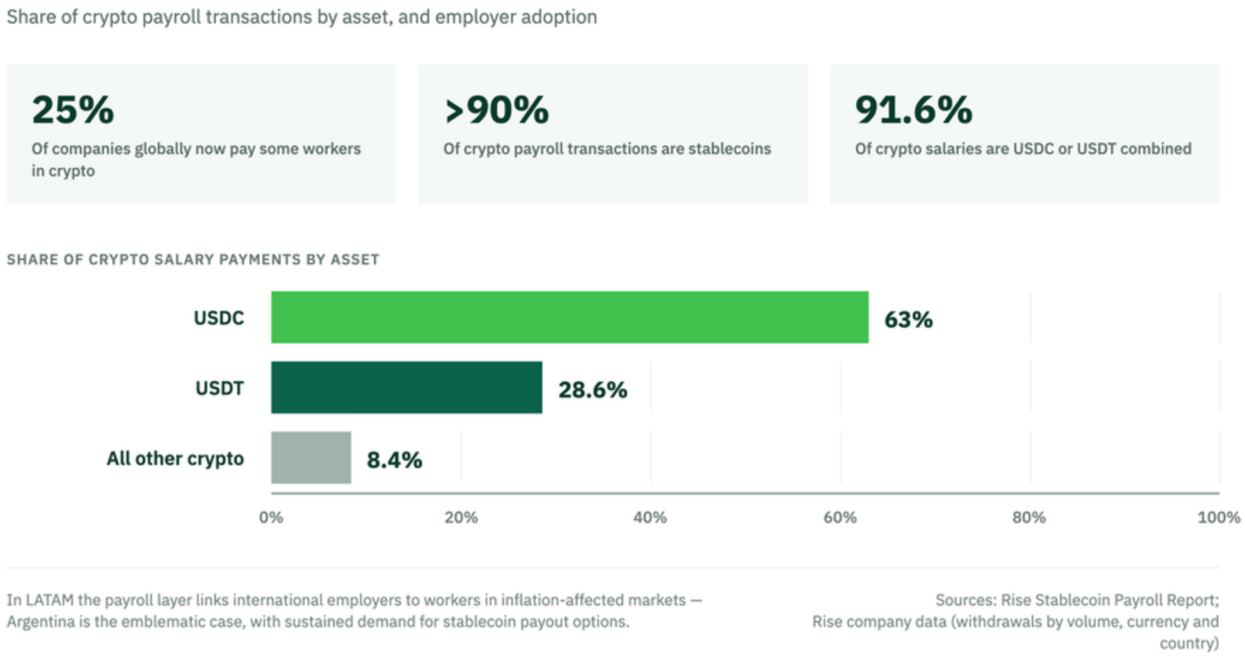
Layer 4 (Distribution): exchanges, wallets, and the card bridge

Distribution is where stablecoins meet consumers and businesses: **exchanges (64% of regional activity), wallets, fintech apps, and increasingly cards.** Regional card infrastructure now supports programs denominated and settled directly in USDC, letting companies with stablecoin treasuries run card programs with no FX conversion layer while remaining fully compatible with existing card networks; merchants continue receiving settlement in their preferred currency (Source: Pomelo company data). C**ard-linked stablecoin spend was the fastest-growing payment category after B2B, up 673% year-on-year in 2025** (Source: McKinsey & Artemis, via AMBCrypto).



Layer 5 (Payroll): how on-chain dollars become recurring income

The payroll layer sits directly above distribution: it is how on-chain dollars become recurring income rather than one-off transfers. **Globally, 25% of companies now pay some workers in cryptocurrency; stablecoins account for over 90% of crypto payroll transactions**, with USDC alone holding a 63% share of crypto salaries and USDT 28.6% (Source: Rise Stablecoin Payroll Report). In Latam, the payroll layer connects international employers to workers in inflation-affected markets, with platform withdrawal data tracked by volume, currency (fiat and stablecoin), and country showing sustained regional demand for stablecoin payout options, Argentina being the emblematic case (Source: Rise company data).



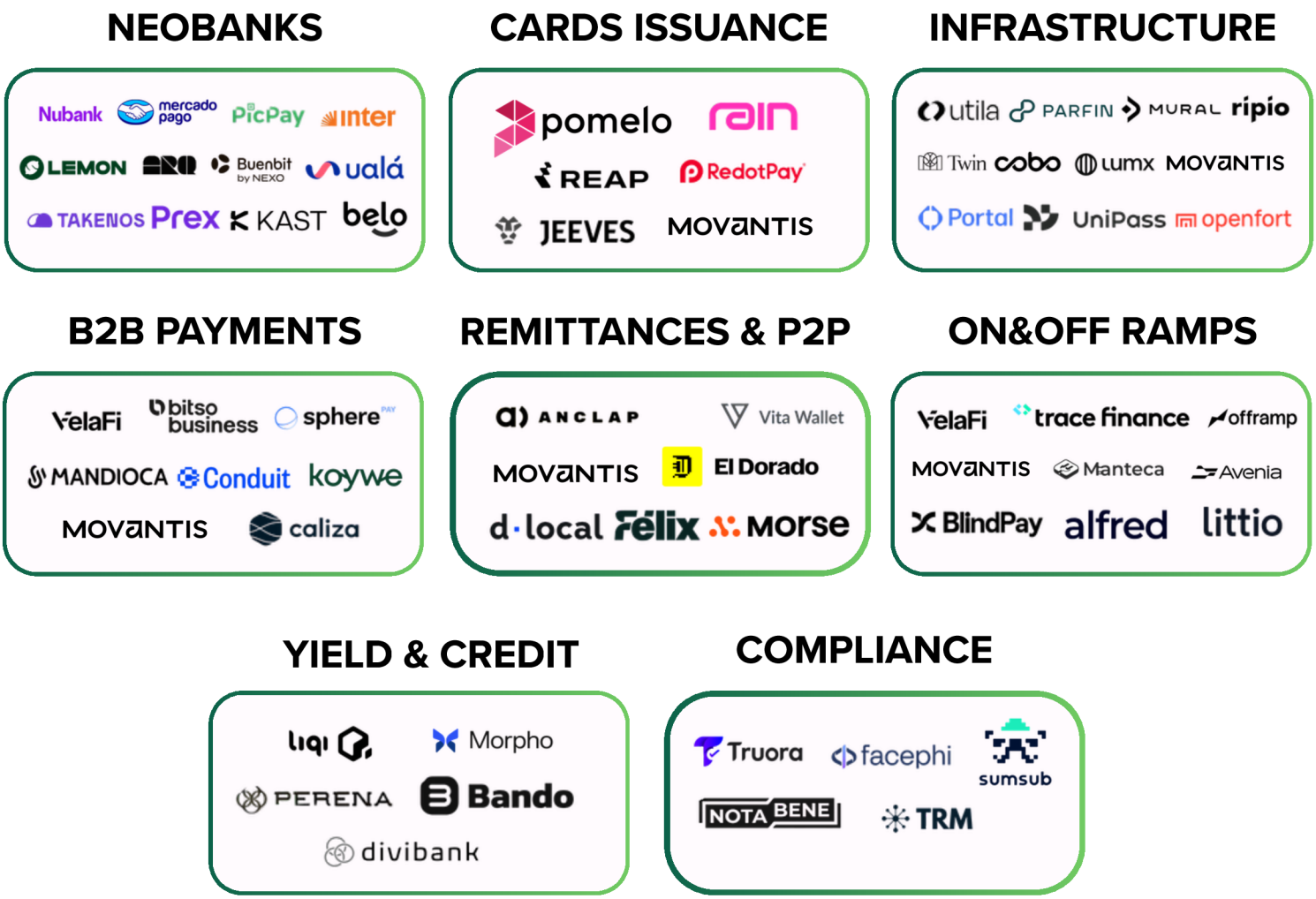
Anatomy of one transaction: how the layers physically connect

A US company pays a contractor in Buenos Aires. Dollars become USDC (Layer 1), cross a settlement rail (Layer 2), reach a payroll platform (Layer 5) where the worker selects a payout currency, and are either held as digital dollars in a wallet (Layer 4) or off-ramped through licensed liquidity into pesos via CVU transfer (Layer 3). The identical anatomy, with the settlement leg on-chain and the disbursement leg on local rails, appears in a $250,000 supplier payment to Shenzhen and a $500 salary payout to Córdoba. Structural repetition across ticket sizes five orders of magnitude apart is the strongest evidence available that this is general-purpose settlement infrastructure rather than a niche product.

5

The Ecosystem Map

THE LATAM STABLECOIN ECOSYSTEM MAP 2026



Chiara Munaretto
Stablecoin Insider

x pomelo

The five case studies that follow profile one operator per critical layer, each using the same template: snapshot, what it does, key data, corridor/market context, why it matters, leadership view.

Case Study: Mandioca

Stablecoin Settlement for Real Trade

Mandioca facilitates cross-border B2B payments for importers and exporters across Latin America, Asia, and the United States, using stablecoin infrastructure as the settlement layer between local-currency legs on each side (Source: Mandioca company data).

Since inception, the platform has processed over U**SD 1 billion in transaction volume across more than 100 enterprise clients, with over 90% of volume tied to real trade activity**: supplier payments, inventory purchases, and international procurement. Typical transaction sizes range from **USD 20,000 to USD 250,000, with many enterprise transactions exceeding those amounts. The fastest-growing corridors are Latam→China, Latam→Hong Kong, US→Latam, and China→Latam.** Settlement falls from 2-5 business days via correspondent banking to same-day, often minutes, with nearly all transactions completed within 24 hours (Source: Mandioca company data).

Mandioca's flows sit squarely in the fastest-growing category of the global market: B2B supplier payments, **which grew 733% worldwide in 2025** (Source: The Defiant). Its client base spans the region's two clearest macro stress cases: Bolivian importers **navigating 80-95% parallel-market dollar premiums** and Colombian importers **absorbing roughly 15% annual peso depreciation** (Source: Mandioca company data).

The operating insight is that adoption is driven by dollar access as much as speed. Businesses across the region increasingly use stablecoins not as a crypto product but as a practical way to access, hold, and transfer dollar-denominated value; the resulting benefits, faster access to global liquidity, reduced settlement friction, and a more predictable mechanism for paying international suppliers, translate directly into working capital, since businesses no longer pre-fund accounts across jurisdictions or hold excess capital against settlement delays (Source: Mandioca company data).

Stablecoins are becoming the financial infrastructure behind international trade.

Most businesses using our platform do not think about blockchain at all. They simply expect money to move as fast as information.

The winners in this market will be the companies that make the technology invisible while delivering better outcomes for global commerce.

Leandro Meneses

Founder & CEO, Mandioca

Case Study: Movantis

Stablecoins Inside Regulated Remittance Infrastructure

"Movantis" is a trademark used to represent the collective capabilities, products, and services offered by Transnetwork LLC and its subsidiaries ("Movantis"). Movantis operates the regulated infrastructure layer connecting money transmitters, banks, and payout locations across the region; a layer no other operator in this region occupies.

Built on more than 20 years of operating depth in the U.S.-Latam corridor, it routes both traditional and stablecoin rails through a single integration, with stablecoin settlement embedded as one more "per-transaction" option, rather than a replacement of the legacy network. Movantis operates a U.S.-licensed money transmitter that acts as an Originating Financial Institution (OFI), while also operating Beneficiary Financial Institutions (BFI) across Latam markets. Movantis is also a member of the Circle Payments Network. Beyond settlement, institutions can access card issuing, white-label wallet infrastructure, FX and liquidity management, and virtual accounts, each delivered by the corresponding regulated entity (Source: Movantis company data).

Through regulated subsidiaries, Movantis holds **60+ licenses** across the Americas, including active money transmission licensing across all 50 U.S. states, and operational standing in 15+ Latam markets, **connecting 50+ money transmitters and banks** to 90,000+ payout locations and 250,000+ cash locations, processing $63B+ in annual volume and **200M+ transactions**. Stablecoin settlement through the Circle Payments Network is concentrated on the interbank leg, where 24/7 availability eliminates batch windows and prefunding requirements (Source: Movantis company data; Circle).

The network sits at the intersection of the two structural dynamics this report documents: the growth of digital stablecoin rails and the persistence of physical last-mile infrastructure. Those two things are not in tension; they are the architecture. The stablecoin leg handles institutional settlement where it performs best; the local rail network handles last-mile delivery through regulated entities where no blockchain reaches without licensed presence (Sources: BBVA Research; Banxico; Movantis company data).

Licensing, local liquidity, and last-mile connectivity take years to build and cannot be accelerated with capital. **For institutions connecting through the Movantis network, that compliance infrastructure, built and held by regulated subsidiaries across each jurisdiction, is already in place rather than assembled market by market.**

Stablecoins solved the value movement.

They didn't solve landing it in local currency, compliantly, across every market in the region.

In Latam, the last mile is still the hardest mile, and it doesn't run on-chain.

Gustavo Ruiz,

Chairman & CEO, Movantis

Case Study: Pomelo

Cards as Bridge to Everyday Spending

Pomelo has built card-issuing infrastructure that adapts to each market's regulatory, payment, and credit specifics: it first consolidated local issuing across Latin America and now issues globally across 150+ countries through a single integration, with debit, prepaid, and credit programs settling in local currency, USD, or USDC depending on the use case (Source: Pomelo company data).

Local cards issued within a specific country typically see around 80% domestic and 20% cross-border transactions, benefiting from lower interchange on most of their volume; global cards issued from a single jurisdiction run 90-95% cross-border. **Domestic transactions cost approximately 5-15% of what cross-border transactions cost, creating fundamentally different unit economics between the two models.** For companies with stablecoin treasuries, settling card programs directly in USDC, whether local or global, eliminates FX conversion costs entirely (Source: Pomelo company data).

The card layer addresses the region's clearest structural gap: Latam operates in a multi-rail reality where cash, cards, real-time systems like PIX, and stablecoins coexist, each serving different use cases, and while stablecoins excel at cross-border movement and treasury operations, cards remain the dominant interface for everyday consumer spending. **With 64% of regional crypto activity on centralized exchanges, the region is primed for infrastructure connecting on-chain holdings to off-chain spend (**Source: Pomelo company data, citing Chainalysis). **Globally, card-linked stablecoin volume grew 673% in 2025** (Source: AMBCrypto).

The strategic playbook the infrastructure enables, launching global cards to validate demand quickly across multiple markets and then layering in local cards as specific countries reach scale, is only possible on rails-agnostic infrastructure, and it is the practical mechanism by which the region's holding-to-spending transition gets built (Source: Pomelo company data).

Latam operates across multiple payment rails: cards, account-to-account, and now stablecoins.

It's a multi-rail ecosystem in a complex region defined by regulatory asymmetries across markets.

The opportunity isn't about picking a winning rail; it's about combining them intelligently.

Gastón Irigoyen

CEO & Co-Founder, Pomelo

Case Study: Rise

Payroll as the Labour Layer

Rise operates hybrid fiat-crypto payroll for international teams, letting employers fund payroll in fiat or stablecoins while each worker selects their own payout mix, with withdrawal data tracked by volume, currency (fiat and stablecoin), and country across Latin America (Source: Rise company data)**.**

Stablecoins account for over 90% of crypto payroll transactions globally, with USDC at a 63% share of crypto salaries and USDT at 28.6%; freelancers have led adoption, with over 25% globally opting for partial crypto payments, concentrated in software development and design roles (Source: Rise Stablecoin Payroll Report). Platform withdrawal data shows sustained Latam demand for stablecoin payout options, with Argentina the emblematic market (Source: Rise company data).

Payroll and remittances together represented roughly $90 billion of 2025's real stablecoin payment volume, the second-largest category after B2B (Source: Stablecoin Insider analysis of McKinsey/Artemis data). In Latam the driver is the inflation dynamic documented in Chapter 2: workers in markets like Argentina converting pay into digital dollars on salary dates (Source: Dune / Bitso).

By offering stablecoin payout options, companies gain access to highly skilled talent pools in countries experiencing persistent inflation, while professionals in those markets gain access to international employers who were previously deterred by payment complexity and currency volatility.

Removing the payment barrier changed the labour market itself, and adoption has moved well beyond crypto-native firms into agencies, startups, and global businesses with international teams (Source: Rise company data).

The biggest misconception about stablecoin payroll is that it's only for crypto companies.

What we're seeing today is agencies, startups, and global businesses adopting stablecoin payroll because it simply works better for international teams.

Hugo Finkelstein

CEO, Rise

Case Study: VelaFi

the Asia-Latam Corridor End to End

VelaFi serves import/export companies, logistics firms, fintechs, and cross-border e-commerce that need to move money across regions without setting up a legal entity in every country, and a growing base of SMBs with cross-border supplier relationships, resolving Latam's local-rail fragmentation (SPEI, PIX, CVU, Bre-B) through a single integration covering the corridor end-to-end (Source: VelaFi company data).

The platform processed 300%+ volume growth in 2025 versus 2024, driven primarily by import/export and logistics clients, with 20%+ growth recorded in the three months to mid-2026 alone. **VelaFi now serves 1,000+ institutional clients across 200+ countries and territories,** with cross-border e-commerce emerging as a new segment. Supplier payments concentrate most of the volume; treasury use cases remain early. SMBs are the fastest-growing segment, a pace the company expects to hold into 2026 as the corridor matures (Source: VelaFi company data).

The Asia-Latam corridor operates under fundamentally different conditions than mature cross-border flows: higher FX volatility, a more complex compliance environment, and substantial per-country differences in regulatory frameworks, FX controls, and preferred payment methods on the Latam side, which means the bar for infrastructure quality is higher, not lower (Source: VelaFi company data). Globally, the destinations mirror this: China Mainland and Hong Kong are the second- and third-largest recipients of cross-border stablecoin payments (Source: The Defiant).

The most significant shift VelaFi observes is not in the corridor's mechanics but in who is showing up to use it: **demand is broadening beyond the import/export and logistics companies** that built the corridor's early volume, and SMBs that previously had no path into cross-border stablecoin infrastructure are actively seeking it out, **a different growth pattern that signals where the next phase of volume comes from** (Source: VelaFi company data).

Everyone assumes this corridor will be won on technology: speed, APIs, blockchain rails. It won't.

It'll be won by whoever understands both sides well enough to make compliance and local knowledge invisible to the customer.

That's a much harder thing to build than a faster rail, and it's why we think the market will consolidate hard over the next two years.

Maggie Wu

CEO & Co-Founder, VelaFi

6

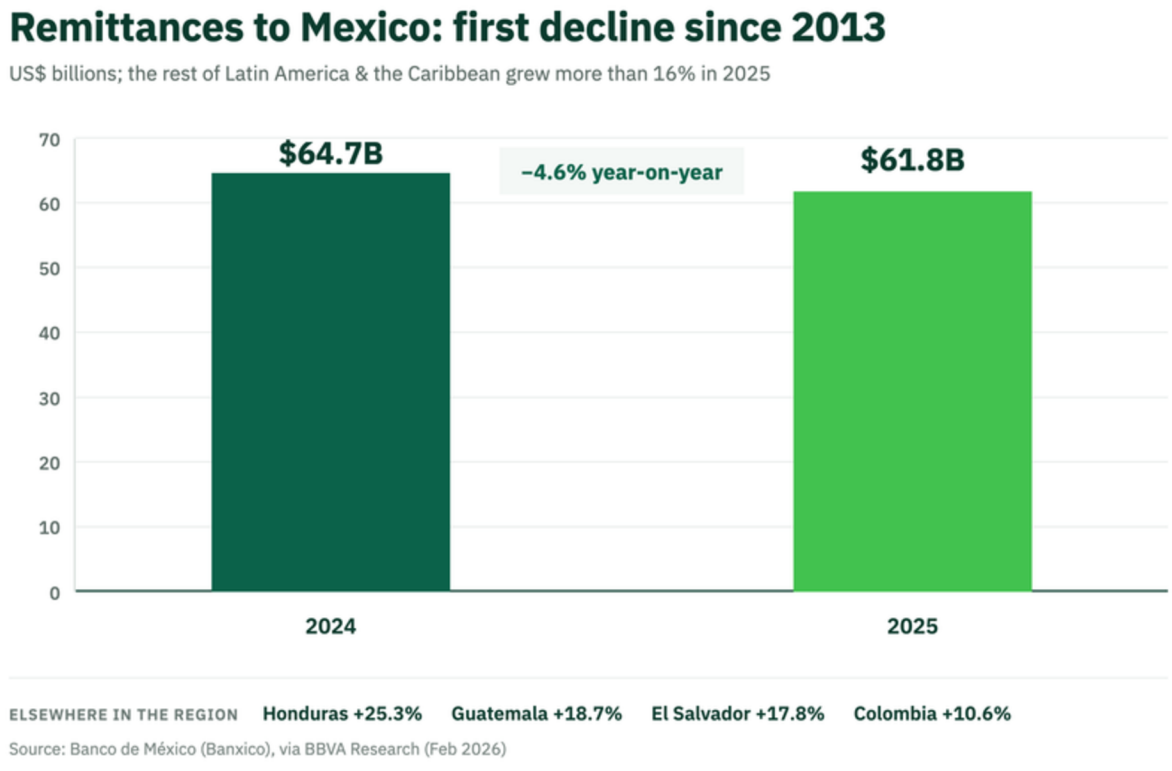
The Corridors

The Corridors: Latam-US, Latam-Asia, Intra-Latam

Latam-US: remittances and B2B

Flow types: consumer remittances (south-bound), contractor/payroll payouts (south-bound), B2B supplier and services payments (both directions).

The US-Mexico corridor is the largest single remittance corridor in the world. Mexico received $61.8 billion in 2025, down 4.6% from the record $64.7 billion in 2024, the first annual decline since 2013 and the largest since 2009, with more than 95% originating in the United States; the drop reflects reduced migration flows, tightened enforcement, and a stronger peso rather than any change in the underlying dependence (Sources: Latin Times, citing Banxico; FXC Intelligence). Remittances to the rest of Latin America and the Caribbean grew by more than 16% in the same year (Source: BBVA Research).



Legacy transfers on this corridor carry the global cost structure documented in Chapter 2: a **6.36% average, with banks at 14.99%** (Source: World Bank RPW). In production systems, stablecoin rails offer 24/7 availability with no batch windows, while regulated local rails handle origination and last mile disbursement, each with its own off-ramp and compliance requirements per market (Source: Movantis company data).

The disbursement reality confirms the architecture: of Mexico's electronically received remittances, **49.6% is still collected in cash at physical payout locations, and remittances sent as bank deposits account for the other 50.4%**, a last mile no blockchain reaches without a licensed physical network (Source: Mexico News Daily, citing Banxico).

Regulatory context: US origination now operates under the GENIUS Act's federal stablecoin framework (Source: Forbes). Mexico's 2018 Fintech Law permits public crypto use but bars regulated financial institutions from offering virtual-asset services directly to customers, pushing stablecoin activity through exchanges and specialised providers; a May 2026 Senate initiative (the Murat Initiative) would create a formal regime for peso-referenced stablecoins across ten financial laws (Sources: CCN; Legal Paradox).

Everyone says they can serve this corridor. **Very few can do the daily compliance and operational work it actually takes, and most quietly let go once they try.**

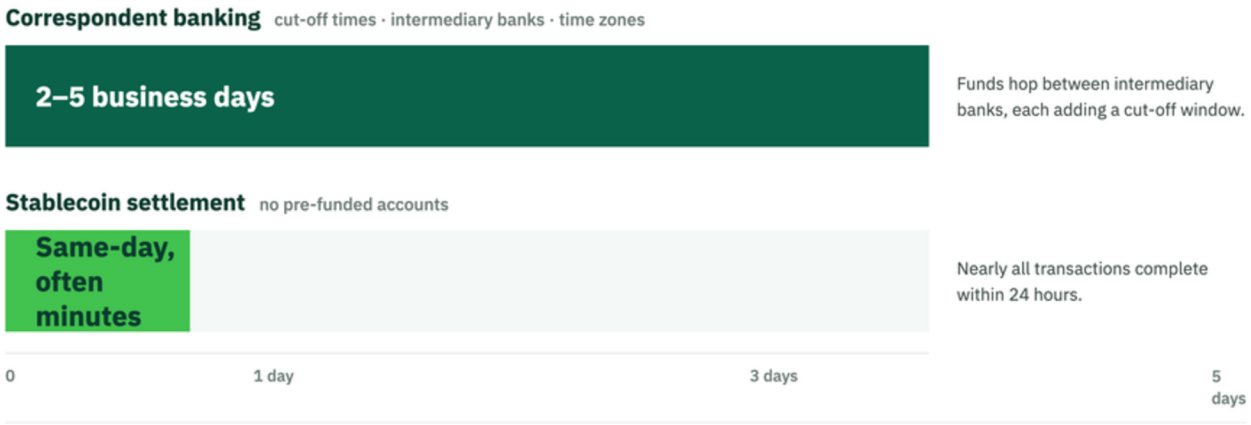
What's left are the teams with real local depth on both ends. That difficulty isn't a problem to solve. It's the reason this corridor rewards the operators who stay.

Maggie Wu,
CEO & Co-Founder, VelaFi

Latam-Asia: the trade corridor

Flow types: import supplier payments (dominant), inventory purchases, procurement, logistics settlement.

This is the corridor where stablecoins have most decisively displaced correspondent banking, because the legacy alternative was worst here: historically, trade payments between Latin America and Asia required 2-5 business days to settle, with delays from intermediary banks, cut-off times, compliance reviews, and time-zone differences frequently impacting working capital and supplier relationships (Source: Mandioca company data). Globally, the destination data confirms the pattern: China is the second-largest recipient of cross-border stablecoin payments at nearly $71 billion per month on average, with Hong Kong third at almost $51 billion (Source: The Defiant / Artemis).



Latam→Mainland China and Latam→Hong Kong rank among the fastest-growing corridors for trade-settlement platforms, with typical tickets of USD 20,000-250,000 and settlement compressed to same-day or minutes (Source: Mandioca company data). Corridor-specialist volume grew 300%+ in 2025, with SMBs, which have no treasury team and no banking relationship able to absorb a slow settlement, as the fastest-growing segment (Source: VelaFi company data). **The corridor carries higher FX volatility and a more complex compliance environment than mature corridors**, which raises rather than lowers the bar for infrastructure quality; successful settlement requires local knowledge on both ends, from business culture and payment-timing expectations to the per-country nuances of SPEI, PIX, CVU, and Bre-B (Source: VelaFi company data).

Regulatory context. On the Latam side, each market is its own regime, and Brazil's is changing fastest (see 6.4). On the Asia side, corridor operators navigate Mainland China, Hong Kong, and Southeast Asian frameworks that differ market by market, one reason the corridor rewards operators with regulated presence on both ends (Source: VelaFi company data).

Intra-Latam: the untapped family

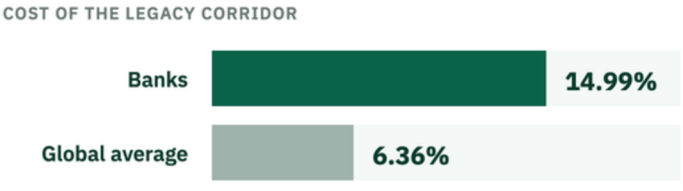
Flow types: regional trade, marketplace settlement, intercompany treasury flows, cross-border consumer payments

Intra-regional flows are structurally underdeveloped relative to the region's trade: **there is no shared currency, no shared rail, and no interoperability between national instant-payment systems, meaning two adjacent economies often settle through New York**. Stablecoins are emerging as the de facto regional interoperability layer between PIX, SPEI, CVU, Nequi, and Bre-B, with the cross-border leg on-chain and each disbursement leg landing on the destination market's local rail, the same architecture documented across every corridor in this report.

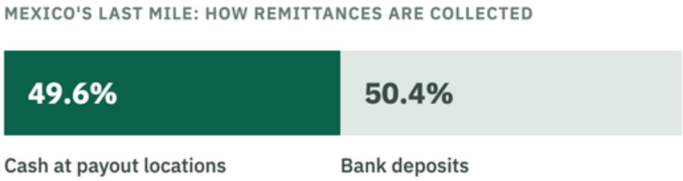
The last mile keeps strengthening on its own trajectory: **PIX processed 79.8 billion transactions in 2025 and is discussing replication and connection with central banks in dozens of countries**, while Colombia's Bre-B connected 218 financial institutions and 33 million users within six months of launch (Sources: PaymentBrief; FiscalNote). As these systems scale, the missing piece is not domestic capability but the settlement bridge between them, which is precisely the gap the stablecoin layer fills.

Stablecoins take the middle leg, not the whole corridor

Where each leg of a remittance actually runs in production systems



Average total cost to send $200 (Chapter 2 baseline).



Nearly half of electronically received remittances are still picked up as cash — a last mile no blockchain reaches without a licensed physical network.

Stablecoins compress the wholesale leg toward zero; origination and disbursement stay on regulated local rails.

Sources: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide; Movantis company data; Mexico News Daily, citing Banxico

The regulatory map, market by market

Stablecoin rules across the region, mid-2026

Framework status by market and what it means in practice

MARKET	FRAMEWORK STATUS	WHAT IT MEANS FOR STABLECOINS
Brazil IN FORCE	Resolutions 519/520/521 (effective 2 Feb 2026); Resolution 561 (effective 1 Oct 2026)	▪ Mandatory VASP licensing ▪ Stablecoin operations classified as FX, with reporting from May 2026 ▪ Licensing transition runs to 30 Oct 2026 ▪ eFX providers barred from stablecoin settlement
Mexico PENDING	2018 Fintech Law; Murat Initiative (May 2026) pending	▪ Legal for the public, restricted for regulated institutions ▪ Peso-stablecoin (AVE) regime proposed across ten financial laws
Argentina IN FORCE	CNV PSAV registry (Res. 994/2024, 1058/2025); AML under Law 27,739	▪ VASP registration mandatory ▪ Includes foreign providers targeting residents
Colombia PARTIAL	No dedicated VASP licensing; Bre-B live	▪ Stablecoin activity operates under general AML rules ▪ Runs alongside the new instant-payment system
Bolivia UNDER REVIEW	Ban lifted 2024; USDT recognition under formal review	▪ State banks already offer USDT products ▪ Would be the region's first officially stablecoin-integrated payment framework

VASP: virtual asset service provider. Dates reflect published effective or transition deadlines as of mid-2026.

7

The CFO & Treasurer Primer

Money That Works: The CFO & Treasurer Primer

What actually changes: the benchmark table

DIMENSION	LEGACY RAILS CORRESPONDENT BANKING / SWIFT	STABLECOIN RAILS
Settlement time LATAM–Asia trade payment	2–5 business days	Same-day, often minutes; nearly all within 24 hours
Availability	Banking hours, cut-offs, time zones	24/7/365
Remittance cost $200, global average	6.36% average; banks 14.99%	On-chain fees measured in cents on high-throughput chains
Visibility	Opaque intermediary chain	Near real-time on-chain tracking
Pre-funding	Required across jurisdictions	Largely eliminated

Stablecoins carry the interbank settlement leg; origination and last-mile disbursement remain on regulated local rails.

Sources: World Bank Remittance Prices Worldwide; Mandioca and Movantis company data

Why the business case is working capital, not fees

Every operator dataset in this report converges on the same conclusion: for treasury teams and CFOs, the most valuable benefit is improved cash conversion cycles and reduced liquidity requirements. Businesses no longer need to pre-fund accounts across multiple jurisdictions or hold excess working capital to manage settlement delays, and for many importers and exporters, those operational and liquidity benefits materially outweigh any direct transaction fee savings (Source: Mandioca company data).

Broader business survey data supports the same conclusion: among businesses that have used stablecoins, 41% report cost savings of 10% or more, mostly on cross-border payments, but the recurring qualitative driver is settlement certainty rather than fee arbitrage (Source: Reap, Stablecoin Statistics 2026).

The most important impact of stablecoin adoption in Latin America is not lower payment costs. **It is the ability to unlock working capital and accelerate trade.**

When settlement moves from days to minutes, businesses can buy inventory faster, pay suppliers faster, and grow without tying up additional capital.

Leandro Meneses,
Founder & CEO, Mandioca

The risk map: five risks, five mitigations

Reserve risk

Is the token backed 1:1? Post-GENIUS Act (US) and under Brazil's Resolution 520, major issuers face statutory reserve, audit, and redemption requirements; Brazil additionally requires independent proof-of-reserves certification for VASP authorisation (Source: Plasma). Mitigation: select issuers by reserve composition and attestation cadence.

Counterparty risk

The exchange, ramp, or custodian holding the position, not the blockchain, is usually the weakest link. Mitigation: licensed counterparties with segregated client assets, as Brazil now mandates under Resolution 520 (Source: Fystack).

Regulatory risk

The perimeter is moving fast. Brazil's FX reclassification brings a 3.5% IOF-Câmbio tax into scope for covered cross-border stablecoin payments from February 2026, a concrete case of a "cheap" rail acquiring fiscal cost once formalised (Source: Avalon Blockchain Consulting). Mitigation: model the regulated cost, not the on-chain cost

Operational risk

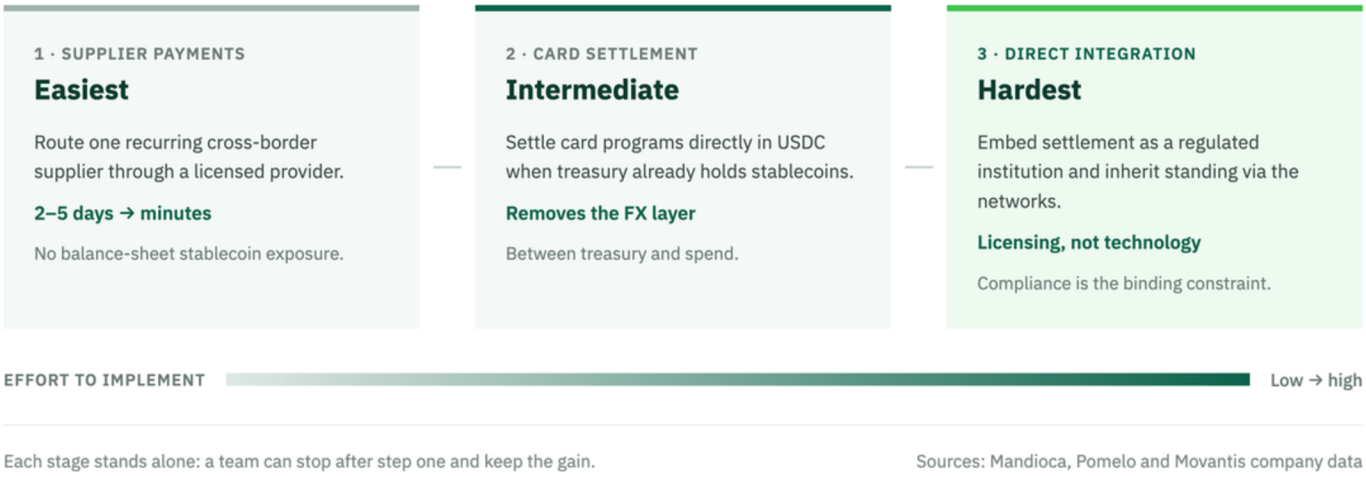
Key management, transaction finality (no recalls), address errors, chain selection. Mitigation: institutional custody, or managed-settlement products where the institution never touches the token; these are now offered at network level, with banks and PSPs interacting entirely in fiat while the network handles minting, orchestration, and compliance (Source: Bitcoin.com News).

Accounting & compliance

Dollar-pegged stablecoins held at par are generally treated as financial assets rather than volatile crypto positions, but jurisdictional treatment varies; in Brazil, cross-border stablecoin operations must be reported within the FX framework, and AML/KYB obligations apply fully at the ramp layer in every major Latam jurisdiction (Source: Plasma).

Three practical entry points, easiest to hardest

Sequenced together, these three steps walk a treasury from a single supplier invoice to full institutional integration, with each stage reversible and each independently ROI-positive.



Each stage stands alone: a team can stop after step one and keep the gain.

Sources: Mandioca, Pomelo and Movantis company data

Entry point 1: Supplier payments (easiest)

Route one recurring cross-border supplier relationship through a licensed stablecoin settlement provider. The benchmark to beat: 2-5 days compressed to minutes-to-same-day, pre-funding eliminated (Source: Mandioca company data). This requires no balance-sheet stablecoin exposure, since conversion happens at the moment of payment, and produces an immediately measurable working-capital result that finance leadership can evaluate after a single quarter.

Entry point 2: Card settlement for spend (intermediate)

If the company already holds stablecoin treasury, common for crypto-native and increasingly for globally distributed businesses, settle corporate or user card programs directly in USDC and eliminate the FX layer between treasury and spend. Program design follows the local/global card economics documented in Chapter 5: an 80/20 versus 90-95% cross-border mix, with domestic transactions costing roughly 5-15% of cross-border ones (Source: Pomelo company data).

Entry point 3: Direct institutional integration (hardest)

For a bank, money transmitter, or fintech embedding stablecoin settlement in its own product, the constraint is not technology: the rail integration is the fast part. The hard part is licensing in each market, a compliance framework that holds across jurisdictions, access to local liquidity, and integration with the local payment rails the beneficiary actually uses. These are the compliance barriers every entry point eventually hits at scale (Source: Movantis company data).

The practical 2026 route is inheritance rather than assembly: connect through networks that already hold regulated standing on both ends of the corridor, rather than building that posture country by country.

When your treasury is already in stablecoins and you're issuing cards to users globally,

eliminating that FX layer isn't just a cost optimization, it's **unlocking an entirely new operating model** where issuers can run payment infrastructure that mirrors their native rails.

Abdul Assal,
Pomelo's General Manager of Global Card

8

Outlook 2026-2027

Key Takeaways

1

Three gaps define the roadmap: merchant acceptance, standardization, and rails-agnostic routing.

2

Brazil's FX reclassification is the regulatory template the region will study.

3

The standout finding: operators at opposite ends of the stack have independently converged on the same architecture, optimal-rail routing under unified compliance.

Spotting the Gaps

Merchant acceptance

The holding-to-spending transition remains incomplete because **the infrastructure connecting stablecoins to traditional payment rails is still maturing**; expansion beyond crypto-native businesses requires payment processors and issuers that can support stablecoin-funded payments while allowing merchants to continue receiving settlement in their preferred currency without taking on digital-asset risk (Source: Pomelo company data).

Card-linked stablecoin volume, though the second-fastest-growing category globally, **remains small in absolute terms at roughly $4.5 billion of 2025's real-payment total** (Source: Stablecoin Insider analysis of McKinsey/Artemis data).

Standardization

Across Latin America, regulatory frameworks are becoming more mature, giving financial institutions greater confidence to build stablecoin-based products; **the next challenge is ensuring that compliance, reporting, settlement, and risk-management capabilities evolve at the same pace as adoption**, making stablecoin-powered financial services as reliable and predictable as traditional payment infrastructure (Source: Pomelo company data).

Rails-agnostic routing: the standout finding

Operators at opposite ends of the stack reached the same conclusion independently. A regulated settlement network:

> *The winning model is not stablecoin-only or traditional-only. It is the one that routes each transaction through the optimal rail under a single compliance standard*
>
> Source: Movantis company data

A card issuer-processor, analysing a different layer entirely:

> ***The winners are not forcing users to choose one rail over another.*** *They are building infrastructure that makes the choice invisible, intelligently routing transactions through the most efficient path based on geography, user type, transaction size, and business model.*
>
> Source: Pomelo company data

When a remittance network and a card platform converge on identical architecture without coordination, that architecture is the market's direction: optimal-rail routing under unified compliance is the design pattern of 2026-2027.

Which corridors open next

Expect the SMB-driven broadening of Asia-Latam to continue: growth in this period will come not only from enterprise volume but from a wider base of smaller players who previously had no access at all (Source: VelaFi company data). **Trade operators expect the same broadening on the demand side**: as settlement friction disappears, adoption spreads from the companies that needed stablecoins to survive dollar scarcity toward companies that simply want faster procurement cycles (Source: Mandioca company data).

On the labour side, **the trajectory is mainstreaming rather than expansion**: stablecoin payroll continues moving beyond crypto-native firms into agencies, startups, and conventional global businesses, because it works better for international teams regardless of industry (Source: Rise company data). Intra-Latam is the largest untapped family, with stablecoins positioned as the settlement bridge between national instant-payment systems as Bre-B scales and PIX pursues cross-border links (Source: FiscalNote).

Bolivia's potential formal recognition of USDT would create the region's first officially stablecoin-integrated national payment framework, a precedent other dollar-constrained economies would study closely (Source: Coin Insider)

The regulatory trajectory

Three vectors dominate:

Brazil's FX reclassification

Brazil's FX reclassification (Resolutions 519/520/521, plus Resolution 561's eFX stablecoin ban from October 2026) is the template other central banks will study: it absorbs stablecoins into the supervised FX system rather than banning or blessing them, with licensing, reporting, and tax consequences attached (Source: Plasma).

AML/KYB pressure intensifies

AML/KYB pressure intensifies region-wide, alongside provider consolidation and growing institutional entry from banks and larger corporates through 2026-2027 (Source: VelaFi company data).

International spillover

International spillover continues: GENIUS Act and MiCA reserve/licensing baselines increasingly shape Latam frameworks, while Mexico's pending legislation would add a peso-stablecoin regime across ten financial laws (Source: Legal Paradox).

What consolidation looks like

The corridor consolidates around operators who make compliance and local knowledge invisible, a harder moat than a faster rail (Source: VelaFi company data). Regulated standing on both ends of a corridor is built over years, not bought with capital, and stablecoins run on top of that requirement rather than removing it (Source: Movantis company data). Brazil's rule barring licensed institutions from transacting with unauthorised counterparties after 30 October 2026 will mechanically force consolidation there (Source: Conduit). Expect licensed, multi-corridor, rails-agnostic operators to absorb single-corridor technology providers, and expect banks entering the market to buy their way in through exactly these platforms.

The bottom line

Latin America spent a decade being described as a crypto adoption story. The data assembled in this report describes something else: a settlement infrastructure story.

The region's largest market conducts virtually all of its crypto activity in dollar tokens; the fastest-growing use case is business supplier payments rather than trading; central banks are writing the tokens into FX law rather than banning them; and every layer of the stack, from trade settlement to corridors to cards to payroll to regulated networks, reports the same three wins: speed, dollar access, and working capital.

Users don't think about blockchain, and the last mile stays on regulated local rails. The infrastructure has become invisible, which is how you know it has become infrastructure.

FAQs

FAQS

How big is the Latam stablecoin market in 2026?

Latin America recorded ~$1.5 trillion in cumulative crypto volume between July 2022 and June 2025, and $324 billion moved via stablecoins in 2025 alone, an 89% year-on-year increase (Sources: Chainalysis; GO Markets).

Why do Latam businesses use stablecoins instead of banks?

Speed and dollar access, not fees: Mandioca's trade-settlement data shows settlement compressing from 2-5 business days to minutes, pre-funded accounts eliminated, and businesses in dollar-scarce or volatile-currency markets gaining reliable access to dollar-denominated value (Source: Mandioca company data).

Which country leads stablecoin adoption in Latam?

Brazil, with $318.8 billion in crypto value received in the last measured 12-month period and over 90% of flows stablecoin-related, per the country's central bank (Source: Chainalysis).

Do stablecoins replace local payment systems like PIX?

No. In production systems, stablecoins carry the cross-border and interbank settlement leg, while regulated local rails (PIX, SPEI, CVU, Nequi, Bre-B) handle origination and last-mile disbursement (Source: Movantis company data).

Are stablecoins regulated in Latin America?

Increasingly, yes. Brazil classifies stablecoin operations as foreign-exchange transactions under central bank Resolutions 519/520/521 (effective February 2026) with mandatory VASP licensing; Argentina requires CNV registration; Mexico's peso-stablecoin legislation is pending; Bolivia is evaluating formal USDT recognition (Sources: ANBIMA; HackenProof; Legal Paradox; Coin Insider).

Our Partners

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MANDIOCA

Cross-border payments facilitator connecting Latin America to global markets, helping importers/exporters move money via stablecoins. $1B+ processed, offices in the US, El Salvador, Hong Kong, and Colombia.

MOVANTIS

Movantis is a unified financial infrastructure platform for real-time cross-border payments across Latin America. Joined Circle Payments Network to add stablecoin settlement to its network, which moves $63B+ annually.

POMELO

Pomelo is an API-first card issuing and payments platform for banks and fintechs worldwide, issuing across 150+ countries with deep roots in Latin America. Clients include BBVA, Santander, and Binance.

RISE

Global payroll platform paying contractors and employees in local currency or stablecoins (USDC/USDT). $1.3B+ processed across 190+ countries, with over half of withdrawals now in stablecoins.

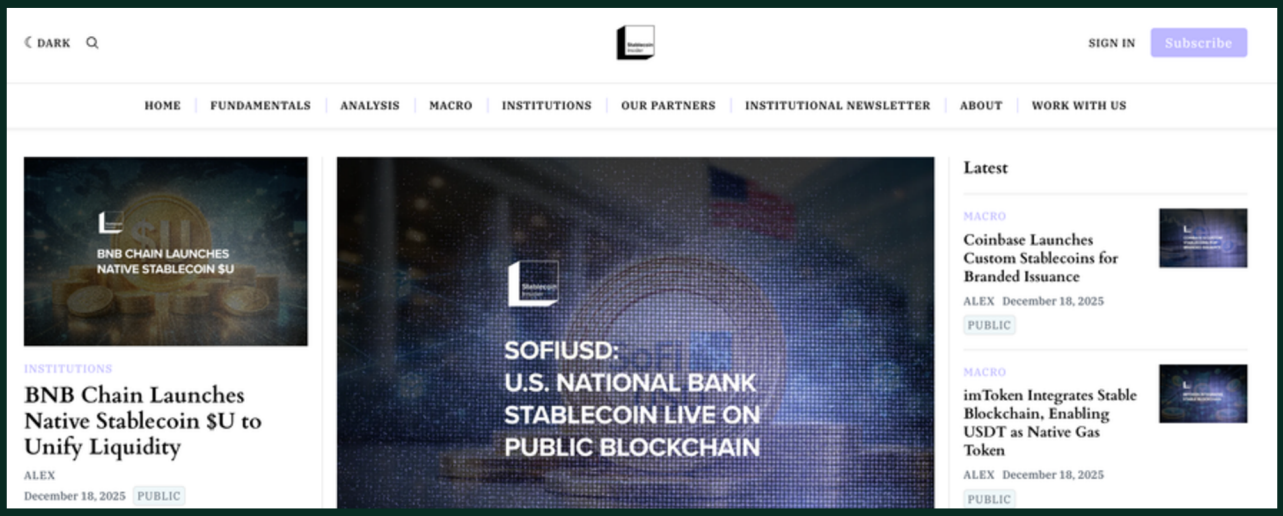
VELAFI

VelaFi is a stablecoin-powered financial infrastructure platform for global businesses, providing on/off ramps, pay-ins and pay-outs, cross-border payments, multi-currency accounts, FX services, liquidity and treasury tools, and secure custody, available directly on the platform or through API integrations.

About Stablecoin Insider

Stablecoin Insider is the leading source for news, data, and expert insights on stablecoins and the future of blockchain-based finance. As global interest in stable digital currencies accelerates, we deliver in-depth, independent reporting on the technologies, platforms, policies, and real-world use cases driving stablecoin adoption worldwide.

Stablecoin Insider works closely with companies across the stablecoin and digital payments stack to help them increase visibility, credibility, and discoverability. On a journey to be the go-to knowledge hub for professionals in the stablecoin space serving the space through articles, reports, interviews, collaborations, and events.



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